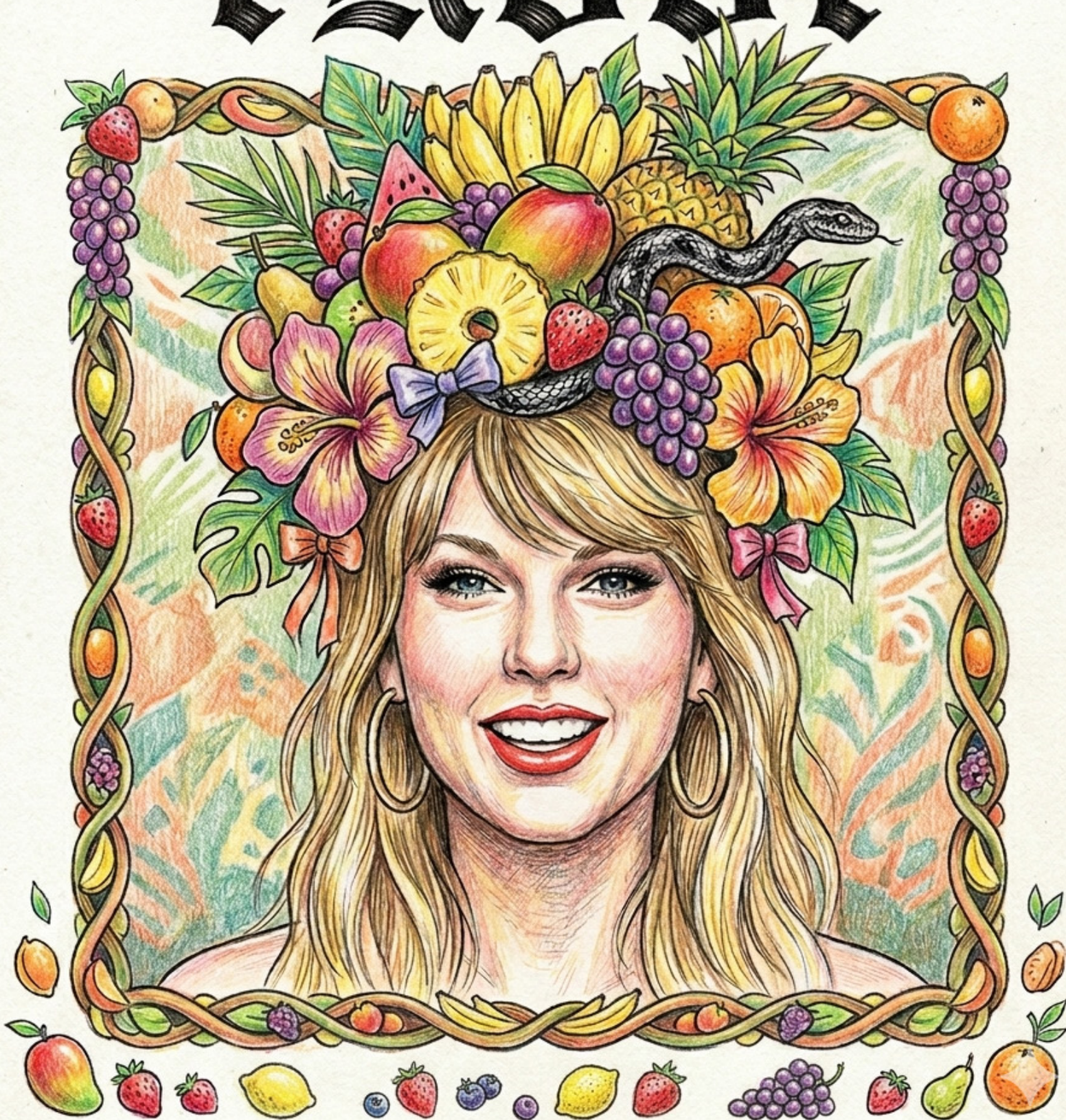


Issue 7

FAROUT

(TAYLOR'S VERSION)

2026



The fR00t

Otto von Frobeniussen
Editor-in-Cheif

Editor's Note: This issue of The fR00t, like the last, is in the form of a "puzzle hunt". The first puzzle is a "metapuzzle", which means that you will need to solve the other puzzles first. This time, the (non-meta) puzzles have a bit more in the way of instructions, so we hope it will be a bit easier for you to get started. We have also given you a bit more guidance on how to extract the answers that you will use to solve the metapuzzle. The answers will likely seem to have little to do with Taylor Swift or the puzzle itself, but they have a commonality that will help you find the final answer, which is a short phrase.

This month's cover art was created by Gemini, given the prompt: Make a picture in a hand drawn style, 8.5x11 portrait size, with "fR00t" at the top in the Taylor Swift "reputation" font, "Taylor's Version" super imposed, and a picture of Taylor Swift with the Carmen Miranda fruit head gear. The coloring should look like colored pencil.

This Month's fRESH Produce

THE LIFE OF A SHOWGIRL..2	Folklore.....10
Kakuro.....3	Midnights.....11
Taylor Swift.....4	Speak Now.....13
reputation.....4	The Tourtured Poets Depart-
1989.....5	ment.....14
Lover.....7	RED.....15
Evermore.....9	

All puzzles written by daggerMason unless otherwise indicated.

Thanks to Adam Hirji, Thomas Nachshen for puzzle testing.

Get Involved!

Write a puzzle and send it to:
froot.magazine@utschools.ca

THE LIFE OF A SHOWGIRL

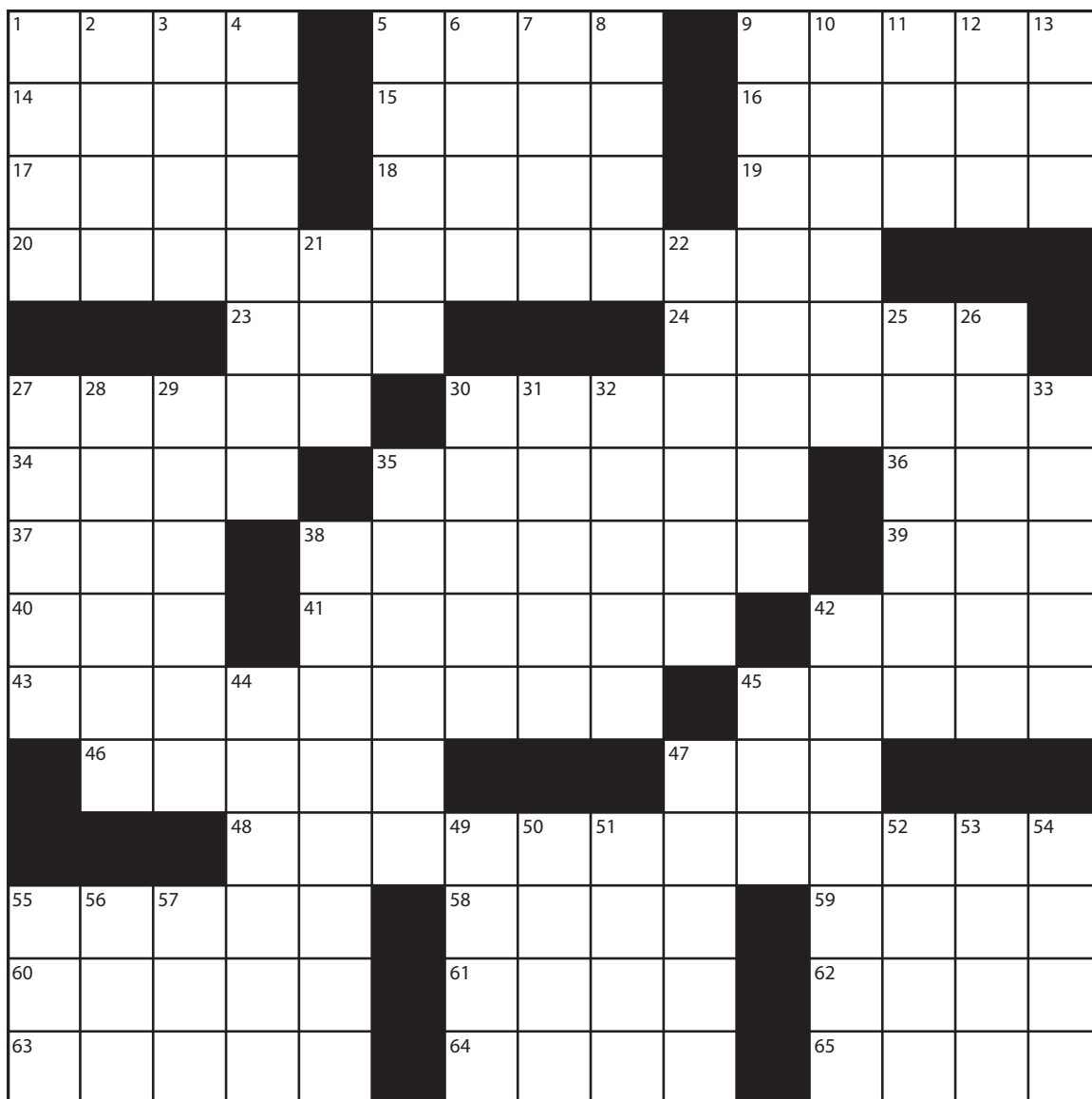
NOTE: The ever-prolific Ms. Swift released "The Life of a Showgirl" well into the planning stages for this issue, so this puzzle is a stand-alone (aka filler), and not part of the "hunt". Enjoy!

ACROSS

1. Degs. from U of T's Rotman Sch.
5. Small anomaly
9. Appropriate
14. Yankee coach and aphorist Berra
15. Bro
16. Chef's protection
17. Eschew
18. Medicinal plant
19. Potala Palace locale
20. The ____ Show (1987-1990)
23. Thread components, shortly
24. Key indicators
27. "Don Juan" division
30. The ____ Show (1963-1966)
34. Pioneering auction site
35. Stray calves, to a cowpoke
36. With 55 across, long-running Al Capp strip
37. Grooved on
38. Fritter
39. "Armageddon" actress Tyler
40. In-flight info, for short
41. Less taxing
42. 1990s Blue Jays pitcher David
43. The ____ Show (1958-1966)
45. Album tracks
46. Bête ____
47. Former Russian orbiter
48. The ____ Show (1967-1978,1991)
55. See 36A
58. Neighbor of Cambodia
59. Nile queen, informally
60. Voltaire's belief
61. Start the pot
62. Capital near the 60th parallel
63. Holds, as an auditorium
64. Admit, with "up"
65. Pull up short

DOWN

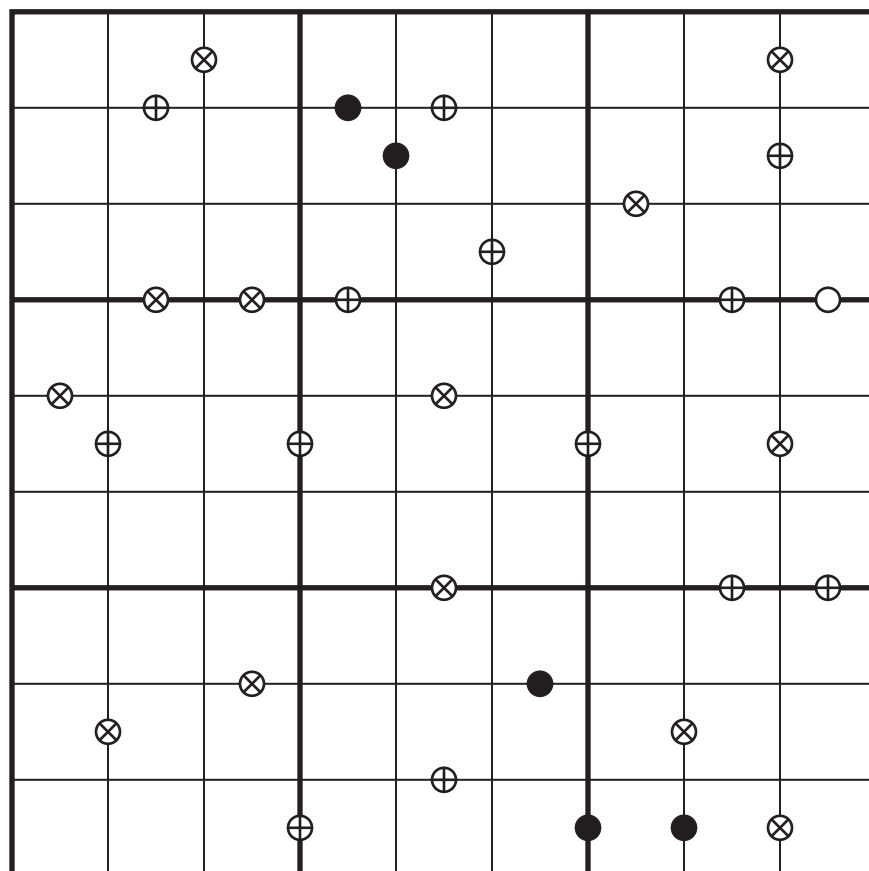
1. Eponymous island in a 1993 video game
2. Physicist Niels
3. Water in Juárez
4. Frank Miller comic series
5. Annual celebrations, briefly
6. Humdinger
7. Pedestal topper
8. Region that includes Brampton and Caledon
9. Impetus for change
10. Weighed in
11. Sphere
12. "Lenore" poet
13. Explosive favoured by Wile E. Coyote
21. Genre for Paramore
22. Canadian author and lawyer Maureen
25. Unconstrained
26. Participating in slalom, perhaps
27. Yielded
28. Adjoin
29. Location of the 1998 Winter Olympics
30. Aplomb
31. Texas A & M athlete
32. Pronged
33. North pole workforce?
35. More valuable
38. Big hug providers?
42. Frosty's pipe type
44. Most congenial
45. Round Table address
47. Ponders dreamily
49. Snowman animated by 52D
50. Kent and Olsen's colleague
51. Automated agents
52. "Frozen" queen
53. Show partner
54. Surname of Bilbo Baggins's mother
55. Pop-ups, e.g.
56. Quilting party
57. Blackalicious's debut album (1999)



Midnights (dagger's version)

This is also filler.

- ⑫ Normal sudoku rules apply.
- ⑫ Midnights: There are nine midnight cells, one in each row, column and box (you will have to deduce their locations). Each digit 1-9 appears once in a midnight cell.
- ⑫ For the purposes of the rules below, the value of a midnight cell is 12, and the value of a non-midnight cell is the digit it contains.
- ⑫ Sums: Cells separated by a $\oplus$ have values that sum to 12.
- ⑫ Products: Cells separated by a $\otimes$ have values that multiply to 12.
- ⑫ Kropki sequence dots: Cells separated by a white circle have values that differ by 1
- ⑫ Kropki ratio dots: Cells separated by a black circle have values that are in a ratio of 1: 2



Taylor Swift

In addition to being a world-wide pop sensation, Taylor has been instrumental in her fiance's success out on the gridiron. On her last tour, she made a point of meeting with a player from each team in every city she visited. At the end, Taylor had a long talk with Travis incorporating everything she had learned. What did she help Travis do?

reputation

Rather than have an election, the students at Taylor Swift High decided to pick their class president by assigning each letter a distinct integer value from 1 to 26. Each student's "reputation" is below.

BELINDA	114	JILLIAN	171	PRISCILLA	164
CHARLES	94	JINWOO	121	QUENTIN	97
DEBORAH	68	JORGE	60	ROGER	41
DELROY	73	KHALID	109	SAOIRSE	92
DOROTHY	73	KUMAR	72	VIVIAN	99
FAROOQ	82	PETER	16	XENIA	83

When you have finished, enter the alphabet ordered by value (lowest to highest), into the answer checker. Entering the correct sequence of 26 letters will give you a message containing the answer.

1989

FEARLESS

When you have solved all the clues, the words in the right-hand column will be the same words in the left-hand column with the suffix "-less". The number in the bracket indicates the letter you should take from that word. Join the word pairs with a ruler to get the correct order for a clue to extract the answer.

Leap [4] •					• Futile
				1	
Mind [4] •	2	5			• Gloomy
				4	
Apple, e.g. [1] •		9	10	10	• Like drones with no central control
				7	
Crush [2] •					• Indefatigable
		9	3		
Author Fielding [3] •				2	• Infinite
Roster [2] •		3			• Inimitable
				11	
Courtroom submission [6] •				7	• Lackadasical
				6	13
Look (at) [4] •			8		• Lacking any citizenship
				11	
Nine-point piece [1] •				4	• Negligent
		13	12	2	
Tailor's line [1] •		1	8	6	• Pristine
Espy [3] •				1	• Smooth
		4			
Assert [4] •				8	• Still
				5	
Rim attachment [1] •		12			• Unfounded

Lover

Each poem is an ode to a common phrase ending in "file" or "files". Use the first letters of each phrase to extract the answer.

by Alpert Hirsch Scowler and daggerMason

Ogg or wave or mp3,
AIFF or ACC,
If it's made of bits,
And you listen to it,
Then that is the format for me.

I'll ne'er be so fully alive,
As when reading this series by Clive.
I for some reason need
To voraciously read
Of Kurt Austin's next deep sea dive.

A particular passion of mine,
Is when people are forming a line,
I'm always most pleased
With no twos or threes
But just one in front and behind

Costanza did zip,
At a job he never had;
The barber was miffed.

My fav 'rite spy tale's a great one,
This point, I'll never be swayed on.
It was made for the screen,
With Caine, Doleman and Green,
From a '62 novel by Deighton.

Manicure's dagger,
Blunt and engraved with diamonds,
Rough edges, refined.

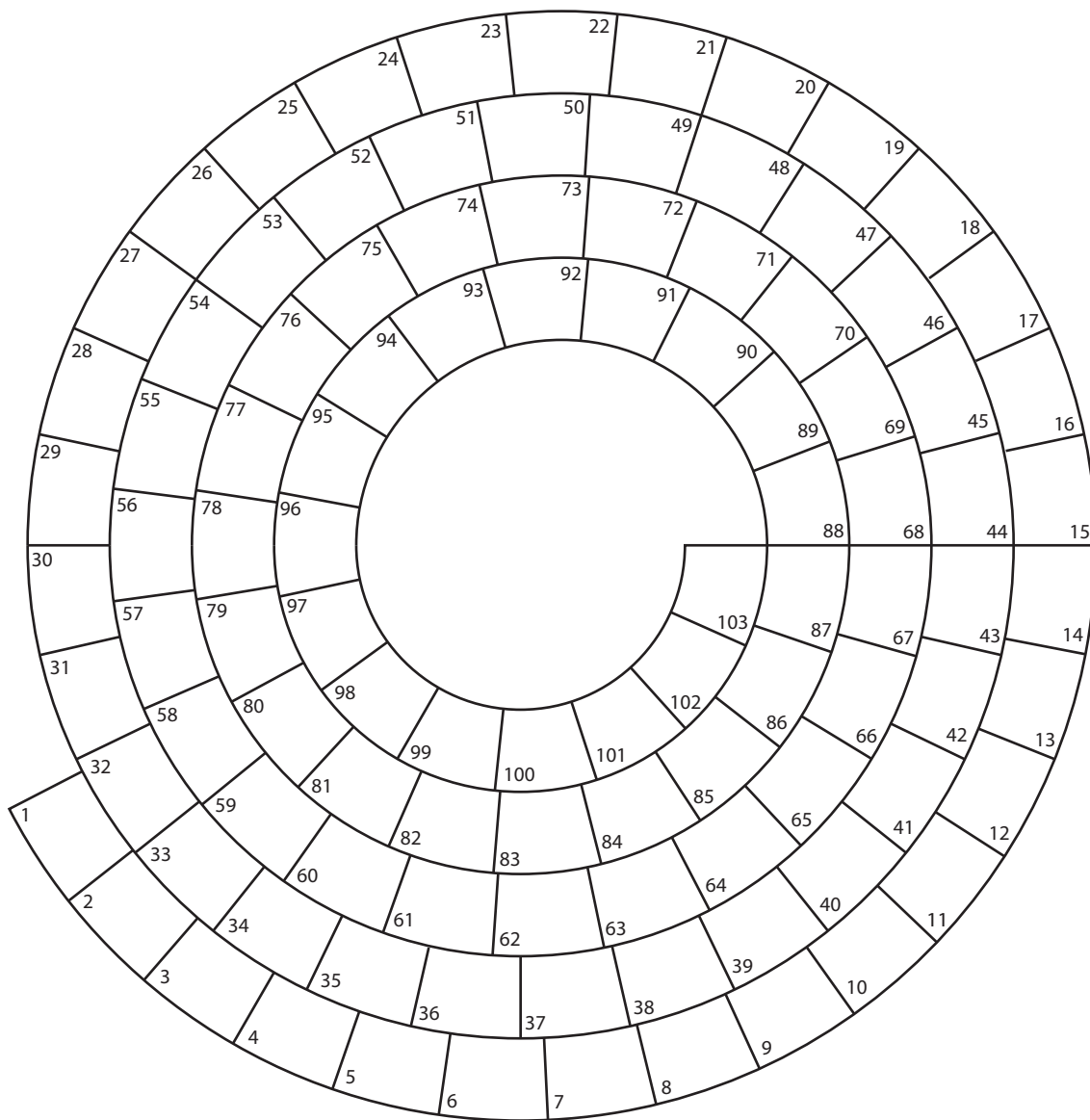
While I'm quite unlikely to choose,
To sign off on most of her views,
It's quite entertaining,
When Megyn's complaining,
About others spreading "fake news"

You may be fond of your G-Sheets,
But for my precious data, none beats
The one from Bill Gates
That consistently rates
Number one with those in the C-suites.

I dig Baracek and Columbo,
Jim Garner is my number one though.
I'm a big nerd
For his gold Firebird,
And completely run-down Winne-bungo.

evermore

Solve the clues and enter the words in the indicated cells. Six cells are used only once: three only inbound, three only outbound. Read the extra letters in that order to extract the answer.



INBOUND

1. Reset the speed, musical-ly (2 wds)
7. Playful marine mammal (2 wds)
15. Series starring Lewis and Giamatti
23. Western sandwich filling
31. Auto-Tune relative
39. Fashionable female of the Roaring Twenties
46. Kleenex, generically
53. Swedish actor
Max von ____
58. Scholars, in Irish Gaelic (var.)

65. Protective embankment
72. Sunken, like some eyes (hyph.)
79. Settle a dispute
89. Grout growth
95. Shot from a pass, in hockey (hyph.)

OUTBOUND

103. Send
98. Funded a scholarship
91. Dessert with a citrus filling (2 wds)
82. Reprimand
76. Radar zone
67. S'more component
56. Homeric hero
48. Update, in military argot
41. Creamy sauce for fettuccine
34. Chevrolet sports car since 1958

26. Furniture polish ingredient (2 wds)
17. La Scala lyrics
9. "Boy Who Cried Wolf" fabulist
4. Facebook's parent company

folklore

Each definition below has had a different transformation applied to each word. When you have figured out the transformation and solved the clue, apply the same transformation to the answer. The resulting strings will all be words from the same category, minus one letter. Those letters, in order, will give you a clue for the answer.

SRSELATIG STSO STSHINS SLSIVIG SOSR SOSCCURIG SISN SWSATR SASLO SPSAT SOSF SASA
SWSS SASNDERSN STSITE

EANING F N CTOTHORPE N USICAL CORE

SSERWIES SSTAWRING SDIEWGO SLUNWA STHAWT SISW SAW SPREWQUEL STOW SROGWUE SONEW

HISTORICPR PHANTEL RACTERIZEDCH BY GLO VEDCU KSTU AN ENOF A CKTH TCO OF RHA

ALLMS UINEME IMALMA TENMO DENMR MB ILDRENMC MA EMT IRMF

DION OUBTDITD INGERDIRS TEFANIDIIS RDIRO REENDING OBLINDING ICTIMDIMV TACYDIYS

NMCKNAMU OOU JERSEU SRORU SAAU NLCOLU PZLIZZU

DOBARDR EAGMER GEFATURINGR LOCLONELR DUMSTARDR DNADR RRPOFESSORR MLPUMR

CUEI NAEI FRI AI RABBTI RI SECODI PATI FI SUPERBOLI XI HALFTIEI PERFORMRI STAEI
NAEI

EGNUOLAD GAGYLLLOLAD ROAD AAD TINUAD FOAD DAERBAD

YCNUOBYC ELOPEL HTIWHT SELDNAHSE DNADN STSERTOOFST RORO GODNROCGO

ETINED RYARD NIMPLEMENT OFOR NGATHERING ELEAVES

JNEYNDYS JWHOWOHW JTEDTRID JSIESOOT JANDADNA JWONWNOW JANANA JCARCCSO JFORFROF
JOUTOTUO JOFOFO JICAIRFA

Midnights

I made a sudoku variant for this section, but it's pretty hard and there's already another variant sudoku in the set, so I made this acrostic instead. If you want to try the sudoku, it's included in the filler section.

1	O	2	N	3	B	4	E	5	A		6	N	7	H		8	C	9	M	10	F	11	B	12	J	13	M	14	L		15	F	16	B	
		17	F	18	K	19	K	20	A	21	J	22	B	23	M		24	H	25	D		26	K	27	E	28	J	29	B	30	M	31	J		
32	K	33	H	34	D	35	H	36	C	/	37	O		38	D	39	G	40	J	41	F	42	E	43	B		44	J	45	D	46	O	47	C	
48	G	49	L	50	B	51	F		52	E	53	C	54	G	55	L	56	A	57	A	58	O		59	I	60	M	61	O		62	B	63	M	
64	K	65	O		66	K	67	J	68	I		69	N	70	N	71	L	72	F	73	L		74	I	75	J	76	G	77	B		78	F		
79	G	80	J	81	B		82	O	83	E	84	N	85	C	86	B	87	O	88	N		89	L	90	C	91	K	92	G	93	D	94	B	95	F
96	E	/	97	A		98	C	99	G	100	H	101	L	102	A		103	I	104	N	105	J		106	E	107	M	108	C	109	F				
110	H	111	M	112	D		113	C	114	L	115	O	116	H	117	A																			

A. Incorporates territory

56	20	57	5	117	102	97
----	----	----	---	-----	-----	----

B. Midnight, et postea

11	94	62	50		22	77	16	3	43	86	29	81
----	----	----	----	--	----	----	----	---	----	----	----	----

C. Big-time pusher

113	53	85	98	47	108	36	8	90
-----	----	----	----	----	-----	----	---	----

D. One who reaps what they sow

25	93	38	34	112	45
----	----	----	----	-----	----

E. Epitome of lightness

106	27	83	4	52	96	42
-----	----	----	---	----	----	----

F. 1995 album by Silverchair

78	51	41	72	17	95	15	109	10
----	----	----	----	----	----	----	-----	----

G. Carp

92	79	99	48	54	39
----	----	----	----	----	----

H. Flat-pitched

76	100	116	24	110	33	7	35
----	-----	-----	----	-----	----	---	----

I. It follows "Morning" in Dallas

74	103	59	68
----	-----	----	----

J. It may come in a hurricane

44	67	12	75		40	80	28	21
----	----	----	----	--	----	----	----	----

K. Mischievous

19	64	32	18	91	26	66
----	----	----	----	----	----	----

L. Game with "bingos" that isn't Bingo

101	49	114	71	55	89	14	73
-----	----	-----	----	----	----	----	----

M. Cram (in)

9	111	63	23	60	13	107	30
---	-----	----	----	----	----	-----	----

N. Trim

69	2	88	84	70	6	104
----	---	----	----	----	---	-----

O. Snoopy's avian associate

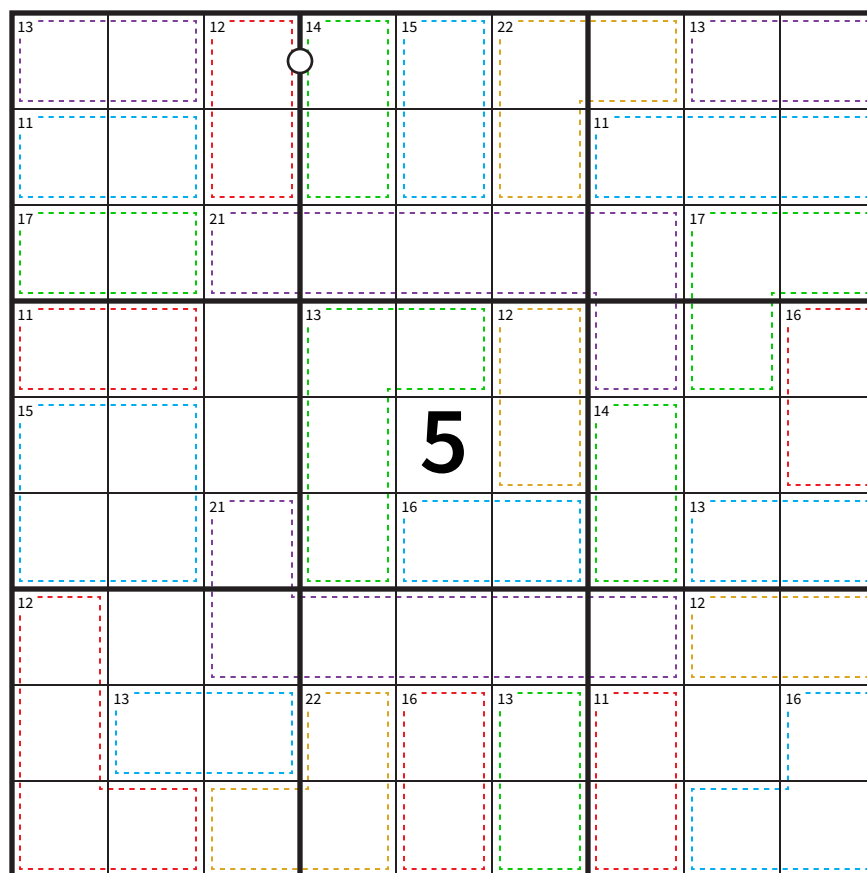
1	61	115	58	37	87	46	82	65
---	----	-----	----	----	----	----	----	----



Every cage in the grid has a twin with the same colour and number (although the shape might be different). One in each pair is a “sum” cage, and the other is a “see-and-say” cage. You will need to deduce through logic which is which as you solve the puzzle.

- Regular sudoku rules apply
- Sum cages: The digits must sum to the number given in the upper left corner. Digits may not repeat in sum cages
- See-and-say cages: Read the number aloud to get the instructions; for example, a see-and-say cage with the number 23 will have two 3s, and a cage with a 17 will contain one 7. See-and-say cages will have digits other than those listed, and digits can repeat if allowed by the other rules.
- Kropki sequence dots: digits separated by a white circle must differ by one

Note: It is possible that a cage will appear to be both “sum” and “see-and-say”; that is, it could simultaneously have the correct sum and contain the correct digit. In this case, you’ll need to figure out this cage’s identity by determining the twin cage’s type independently.



When you have solved the puzzle, enter the digits in the first column into the answer checker. The correct sequence of nine digits will give you a message with the answer for this puzzle.

THE TOURTURED POETS DEPARTMENT

These seven poets (Blake, Cohen, Donne, Eliot, Keats, Plath and Rilke) were each in a different Canadian city last week. Although they spent most of their time composing various volumes of verse, each took a different day out of the week to do a mundane activity. While they didn't exactly enjoy the experience, they figured the adversity would be good fodder for their art. Given the clues, can you figure out everyone's time, place and activity?

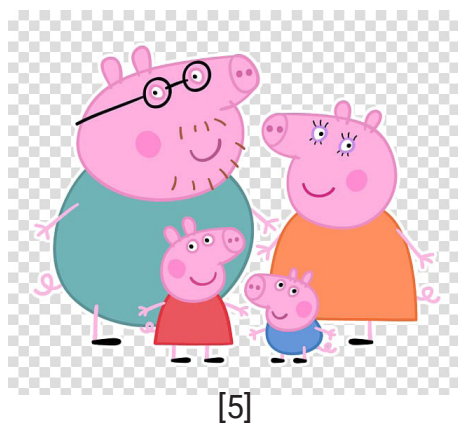
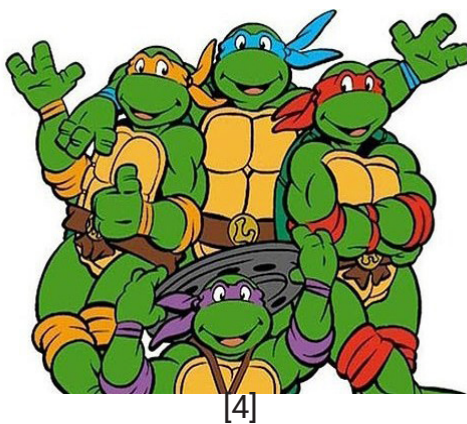
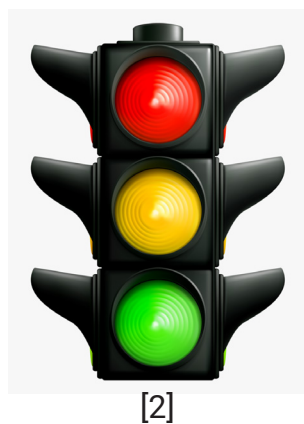
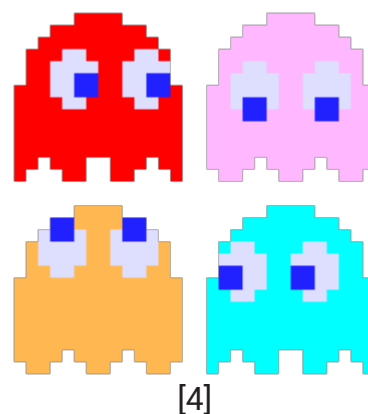
1. The three poets on Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday are, in some order: the one in Windsor, the person vacuuming, and Donne (who did not attend a cocktail party).
2. Taxes and laundry were done on Sunday and Monday, respectively
3. Keats did his activity earlier in the week than the person doing yard work
4. Plath either did her activity on Tuesday, or she watched NASCAR
5. The person in Toronto did their activity the day before the person in Weyburn
6. The poet who went to a cocktail party was either Blake or the person in Oak Bay.
7. The person in Oak Bay did their activity two days before Blake.
8. The poets in Chatham and Calgary did their activities on Sunday and Saturday, in some order
9. Eliot, who did not see Rent or do yard work, did his activity two days after Rilke.
10. A poet saw Rent on one of the last three days of the week.
11. Cohen, who was in Chatham, did his activity before someone went to see Rent
12. The person in Moncton didn't watch NASCAR.

Day	City	Poet	Activity
SUN			
MON			
TUE			
WED			
THU			
FRI			
SAT			

When you are finished, read the letters of the cities diagonally from the top left corner to obtain the answer.

RED

Each picture has one "red" character. The indicated letters of their names, read in the order the pictures are given, will give you a clue to extract the answer.





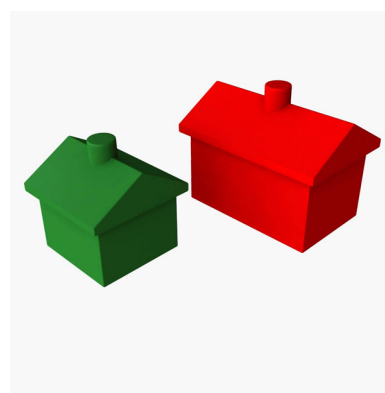
[1]



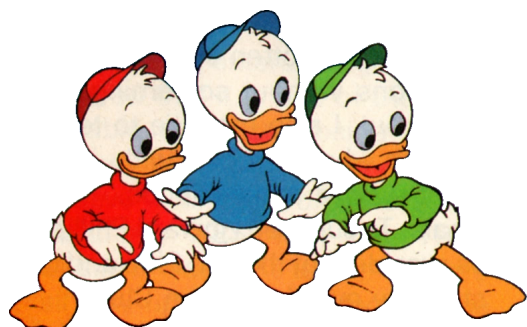
[3]



[6]



[1]



[2]



[5]



[1]



[7]

PUZZLENAME

